

QA LEADERSHIP ACADEMY

Module 4 Assignment — Hiring Great Testers

Assignment brief: scenario, deliverables, steps and how your work is assessed.

About this assignment

Your capability assessment has exposed a gap Northstar cannot grow into fast enough internally, and headcount is scrutinised — a request for three testers will be challenged, but one well-argued hire framed as risk reduction may not. You decide to run an end-to-end hiring process for a single Senior QA Engineer. There is no universal right answer here: the role you scope must follow from the specific gap in your inherited team.

What you'll demonstrate

- Translate a capability gap into a precise role definition
- Design a fair, structured, end-to-end hiring process
- Assess technical and behavioural ability without bias
- Make a defensible final decision and plan the onboarding

What to submit

- A complete QA Hiring Pack for one Senior QA Engineer
- A job description, CV screening scorecard, interview questions, a technical assessment rubric and a behavioural scorecard
- A completed Final Candidate Decision Matrix and a QA Onboarding Checklist

Step-by-step

1. State which team gap this hire closes and why a senior hire, rather than training, is the right call
2. Write the QA Job Description for the role Northstar actually needs
3. Build the CV Screening Scorecard and select questions from the QA Interview Question Bank aligned to the role
4. Design the Technical Assessment Rubric and Behavioural Interview Scorecard so each stage tests something distinct

5. Complete the Final Candidate Decision Matrix for a plausible shortlist and draft the QA Onboarding Checklist for the successful hire

Submission format

Submit as a PDF or DOCX assembling the full hiring pack in the order a candidate would experience it.

How your work is assessed

If a QA lead reviewed this, they would look for:

- A role scoped from a real, stated capability gap rather than a generic senior tester
- A structured process that reduces bias and is consistent across candidates
- Assessment stages that each measure something different and defensible
- A decision matrix that produces a clear, justifiable recommendation
- An onboarding plan that gets the hire productive and integrated quickly

Templates & resources to use

- QA Job Description Template — find it in the Resource Vault.
- CV Screening Scorecard — find it in the Resource Vault.
- QA Interview Question Bank — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Technical Assessment Rubric — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Behavioural Interview Scorecard — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Final Candidate Decision Matrix — find it in the Resource Vault.
- QA Onboarding Checklist — find it in the Resource Vault.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Define what "good" looks like before you meet a single candidate. Scorecards written in advance are how you hire on evidence rather than on the person who interviewed most confidently.